

What happened?

Sixty-five million years ago the dinosaurs died out, along with the pterosaurs and the plesiosaurs. It was a mass extinction, but what was the cause? Many believe it was the result of a meteorite.

What changed?

Scientists now believe a massive meteorite hit Earth, creating a dust cloud of noxious fumes that screened out the Sun and changed the climate.



It was a big one!

In the early 1990s, geologists found the remains of a massive crater in Mexico. It was 180 km (112 miles) wide. They believe it was caused by a meteorite smashing into Earth 65 million years ago.

Who died?

The extinction saw the loss of huge numbers of animals, including:



Pterosaurs, which had once filled the skies with their airborne acrobatics.



Dinosaurs, which had evolved into a huge variety of types.



Huge reptiles, which disappeared from the oceans.

The rock would have hit Earth's crust with terrific force, sending shock waves around the world.